The king returned amidst the silence of a vast multitude to the Palais Royal. All minds were uneasy, most were foreboding, many of the people used threatening language.

At first, indeed, they were doubtful whether the king's visit to the parliament had been in order to lighten or increase their burdens; but scarcely was it known that the taxes were to be still further increased, when cries of 'Down with Mazarin!' 'Long live Broussel!' 'Long live Blancmesnil!' resounded through the city. For the people had learned that Broussel and Blancmesnil had made speeches in their behalf, and, although the eloquence of these deputies had been without avail, it had none the less won for them the people's good-will. All attempts to disperse the groups collected in the streets, or silence their exclamations, were in vain. Orders had just been given to the royal guards and the Swiss guards, not only to stand firm, but to send out patrols to the streets of Saint Denis and Saint Martin, where the people thronged and where they were the most vociferous, when the mayor of Paris was announced at the Palais Royal.

He was shown in directly; he came to say that if these offensive precautions were not discontinued, in two hours Paris would be under arms.

Deliberations were being held when a lieutenant in the guards, named Comminges, made his appearance, with his clothes all torn, his face streaming with blood. The queen on seeing him uttered a cry of surprise and asked him what was going on.

As the mayor had foreseen, the sight of the guards had exasperated the mob. The tocsin was sounded. Comminges had arrested one of the ringleaders and had ordered him to be hanged near the cross of Du Trahoir; but in attempting to execute this command the soldiery were attacked in the market-place with stones and halberds; the delinquent had escaped to the Rue des Lombards and rushed into a house. They broke open the doors and searched the dwelling, but in vain. Comminges, wounded by a stone which had struck him on the forehead, had left a picket in the street and returned to the Palais Royal, followed by a menacing crowd, to tell his story.

This account confirmed that of the mayor. The authorities were not in a condition to cope with serious revolt. Mazarin endeavored to circulate among the people a report that troops had only been stationed on the quays and on the Pont Neuf, on account of the ceremonial of the day, and that they would soon

withdraw. In fact, about four o'clock they were all concentrated about the Palais Royal, the courts and ground floors of which were filled with musketeers and Swiss guards, and there awaited the outcome of all this disturbance.

Such was the state of affairs at the very moment we introduced our readers to the study of Cardinal Mazarin—once that of Cardinal Richelieu. We have seen in what state of mind he listened to the murmurs from below, which even reached him in his seclusion, and to the guns, the firing of which resounded through that room. All at once he raised his head; his brow slightly contracted like that of a man who has formed a resolution; he fixed his eyes upon an enormous clock that was about to strike ten, and taking up a whistle of silver gilt that stood upon the table near him, he shrilled it twice.

A door hidden in the tapestry opened noiselessly and a man in black silently advanced and stood behind the chair on which Mazarin sat.

'Bernouin,' said the cardinal, not turning round, for having whistled, he knew that it was his *valet-de-chambre* who was behind him; 'what musketeers are now within the palace?'

'The Black Musketeers, my lord.'

'What company?'

'Tréville's company.'

'Is there any officer belonging to this company in the ante-chamber?'

'Lieutenant d'Artagnan.'

'A man on whom we can depend, I hope.'

'Yes, my lord.'

'Give me a uniform of one of these musketeers and help me to put it on.'

The valet went out as silently as he had entered and appeared in a few minutes bringing the dress demanded.

The cardinal, in deep thought and in silence, began to take off the robes of state he had assumed in order to be present at the sitting of parliament, and to attire himself in the military coat, which he wore with a certain degree of easy grace, owing to his former campaigns in Italy. When he was completely dressed he said:

'Send hither Monsieur d'Artagnan.'

The valet went out of the room, this time by the centre door, but still as silently as before; one might have fancied him an apparition.

A man in black silently advanced

he had swallowed. Nothing, therefore, was settled that day, as Emery's head was not steady enough for business after such an occurrence.

On the next day Mathieu Molé, the chief president, whose courage at this crisis, says the Cardinal de Retz, was equal to that of the Duc de Beaufort and the Prince de Condé—in other words, of the two men who were considered the bravest in France—had been attacked in his turn. The people threatened to hold him responsible for the evils that hung over them. But the chief president had replied with his habitual coolness, without betraying either disturbance or surprise, that should the agitators refuse obedience to the king's wishes he would have gallows erected in the public squares and proceed at once to hang the most active among them. To which the others had responded that they would be glad to see the gallows erected; they would serve for the hanging of those detestable judges who purchased favor at court at the price of the people's misery.

Nor was this all. On the eleventh the queen in going to mass at Notre Dame, as she always did on Saturdays, was followed by more than two hundred women demanding justice. These poor creatures had no bad intentions. They wished only to be allowed to fall on their knees before their sovereign, and that they might move her to compassion; but they were prevented by the royal guard and the queen proceeded on her way, haughtily disdainful of their entreaties.

At length parliament was convoked; the authority of the king was to be maintained.

One day—it was the morning of the day my story begins—the king, Louis XIV, then ten years of age, went in state, under pretext of returning thanks for his recovery from the small-pox, to Notre Dame. He took the opportunity of calling out his guard, the Swiss troops and the musketeers, and he had planted them round the Palais Royal, on the quays, and on the Pont Neuf. After mass the young monarch drove to the Parliament House, where, upon the throne, he hastily confirmed not only such edicts as he had already passed, but issued new ones, each one, according to Cardinal de Retz, more ruinous than the others—a proceeding which drew forth a strong remonstrance from the chief president, Molé—whilst President Blancmesnil and Councillor Broussel raised their voices in indignation against fresh taxes.

measures, promised to speak in their behalf to the queen, and dismissed them with the ordinary expression of royalty, 'We will see what we can do.'

Two days afterward these same magistrates appeared before the cardinal and their spokesman addressed Mazarin with so much fearlessness and determination that the minister was astounded and sent the deputation away with the same answer as it had received from the Duke of Orléans—that he would see what could be done; and in accordance with that intention a council of state was assembled and the superintendent of finance was summoned.

This man, named Emery, was the object of popular detestation, in the first place because he *was* superintendent of finance, and every superintendent of finance deserved to be hated; in the second place, because he rather deserved the odium which he had incurred.

He was the son of a banker at Lyons named Particelli, who, after becoming a bankrupt, chose to change his name to Emery; and Cardinal Richelieu having discovered in him great financial aptitude, had introduced him with a strong recommendation to Louis XIII under his assumed name, in order that he might be appointed to the post he subsequently held.

'You surprise me!' exclaimed the monarch. 'I am rejoiced to hear you speak of Monsieur d'Emery as calculated for a post which requires a man of probity. I was really afraid that you were going to force that villain Particelli upon me.'

'Sire,' replied Richelieu, 'rest assured that Particelli, the man to whom your majesty refers, has been hanged.'

'Ah; so much the better!' exclaimed the king. 'It is not for nothing that I am styled Louis the Just,' and he signed Emery's appointment.

This was the same Emery who became eventually superintendent of finance.

He was sent for by the ministers and he came before them pale and trembling, declaring that his son had very nearly been assassinated the day before, near the palace. The mob had insulted him on account of the ostentatious luxury of his wife, whose house was hung with red velvet edged with gold fringe. This lady was the daughter of Nicholas de Camus, who arrived in Paris with twenty francs in his pocket, became secretary of state, and accumulated wealth enough to divide nine millions of francs among his children and to keep an income of forty thousand for himself.

The fact was that Emery's son had run a great chance of being suffocated, one of the rioters having proposed to squeeze him until he gave up all the gold

When he was left alone the cardinal looked at himself in the glass with a feeling of self-satisfaction. Still young—for he was scarcely forty-six years of age—he possessed great elegance of form and was above the middle height; his complexion was brilliant and beautiful; his glance full of expression; his nose, though large, was well proportioned; his forehead broad and majestic; his hair, of a chestnut colour, was curled slightly; his beard, which was darker than his hair, was turned carefully with a curling iron, a practice that greatly improved it. After a short time the cardinal arranged his shoulder belt, then looked with great complacency at his hands, which were most elegant and of which he took the greatest care; and throwing on one side the large kid gloves tried on at first, as belonging to the uniform, he put on others of silk only. At this instant the door opened.

'Monsieur d'Artagnan,' said the *valet-de-chambre*.

An officer, as he spoke, entered the apartment. He was a man between thirty-nine and forty years of age, of medium height but a very well proportioned figure; with an intellectual and animated physiognomy; his beard black, and his hair turning gray, as often happens when people have found life either too gay or too sad, more especially when they happen to be of swart complexion.

D'Artagnan advanced a few steps into the apartment.

How perfectly he remembered his former entrance into that very room! Seeing, however, no one there except a musketeer of his own troop, he fixed his eyes upon the supposed soldier, in whose dress, nevertheless, he recognised at the first glance the cardinal.

The lieutenant remained standing in a dignified but respectful posture, such as became a man of good birth, who had in the course of his life been frequently in the society of the highest nobles.

The cardinal looked at him with a cunning rather than serious glance, yet he examined his countenance with attention and after a momentary silence said:

'You are Monsieur d'Artagnan?'

'I am that individual,' replied the officer.

Mazarin gazed once more at a countenance full of intelligence, the play of which had been, nevertheless, subdued by age and experience; and D'Artagnan received the penetrating glance like one who had formerly sustained many

a searching look, very different, indeed, from those which were inquiringly directed on him at that instant.

'Sir,' resumed the cardinal, 'you are to come with me, or rather, I am to go with you.'

'I am at your command, my lord,' returned D'Artagnan.

'I wish to visit in person the outposts which surround the Palais Royal; do you suppose that there is any danger in so doing?'

'Danger, my lord!' exclaimed D'Artagnan with a look of astonishment, 'what danger?'

'I am told that there is a general insurrection.'

'The uniform of the king's musketeers carries a certain respect with it, and even if that were not the case I would engage with four of my men to put to flight a hundred of these clowns.'

'Did you witness the injury sustained by Comminges?'

'Monsieur de Comminges is in the guards and not in the musketeers— '

'Which means, I suppose, that the musketeers are better soldiers than the guards.' The cardinal smiled as he spoke.

'Every one likes his own uniform best, my lord.'

'Myself excepted,' and again Mazarin smiled; 'for you perceive that I have left off mine and put on yours.'

'Lord bless us! this is modesty indeed!' cried D'Artagnan. 'Had I such a uniform as your eminence possesses, I protest I should be mightily content, and I would take an oath never to wear any other costume— '

'Yes, but for to-night's adventure I don't suppose my dress would have been a very safe one. Give me my felt hat, Bernouin.'

The valet instantly brought to his master a regimental hat with a wide brim. The cardinal put it on in military style.

'Your horses are ready saddled in their stables, are they not?' he said, turning to D'Artagnan.

'Yes, my lord.'

'Well, let us set out.'

'How many men does your eminence wish to escort you?'

'You say that with four men you will undertake to disperse a hundred low fellows; as it may happen that we shall have to encounter two hundred, take eight— '

me, and even were I obliged to yield to the populace she would yield with me; if I fly, she will fly; and then we shall see how the rebels will get on without either king or queen.

Oh, were I not a foreigner! were I but a Frenchman! were I but of gentle birth!'

The position of the cardinal was indeed critical, and recent events had added to his difficulties. Discontent had long pervaded the lower ranks of society in France. Crushed and impoverished by taxation—imposed by Mazarin, whose avarice impelled him to grind them down to the very dust—the people, as the Advocate-General Talon described it, had nothing left to them except their souls; and as those could not be sold by auction, they began to murmur. Patience had in vain been recommended to them by reports of brilliant victories gained by France; laurels, however, were not meat and drink, and the people had for some time been in a state of discontent.

Had this been all, it might not, perhaps, have greatly signified; for when the lower classes alone complained, the court of France, separated as it was from the poor by the intervening classes of the gentry and the *bourgeoisie*, seldom listened to their voice; but unluckily, Mazarin had had the imprudence to attack the magistrates and had sold no less than twelve appointments in the Court of Requests, at a high price; and as the officers of that court paid very dearly for their places, and as the addition of twelve new colleagues would necessarily lower the value of each place, the old functionaries formed a union amongst themselves, and, enraged, swore on the Bible not to allow of this addition to their number, but to resist all the persecutions which might ensue; and should any one of them chance to forfeit his post by this resistance, to combine to indemnify him for his loss.

Now the following occurrences had taken place between the two contending parties.

On the seventh of January between seven and eight hundred tradesmen had assembled in Paris to discuss a new tax which was to be levied on house property. They deputed ten of their number to wait upon the Duke of Orléans, who, according to his custom, affected popularity. The duke received them and they informed him that they were resolved not to pay this tax, even if they were obliged to defend themselves against its collectors by force of arms. They were listened to with great politeness by the duke, who held out hopes of easier

incessant sounds of guns firing—let off, happily, without other end or aim, except to show to the guards, the Swiss troops and the military who surrounded the Palais Royal, that the people were possessed of arms.

The shade of Richelieu was Mazarin. Now Mazarin was alone and defenceless, as he well knew.

'Foreigner!' he ejaculated, 'Italian! that is their mean yet mighty byword of reproach—the watchword with which they assassinated, hanged, and made away with Concini; and if I gave them their way they would assassinate, hang, and make away with me in the same manner, although they have nothing to complain of except a tax or two now and then. Idiots! ignorant of their real enemies, they do not perceive that it is not the Italian who speaks French badly, but those who can say fine things to them in the purest Parisian accent, who are their real foes.'

'Yes, yes,' Mazarin continued, whilst his wonted smile, full of subtlety, lent a strange expression to his pale lips; 'yes, these noises prove to me, indeed, that the destiny of favourites is precarious; but ye shall know I am no ordinary favourite. No! The Earl of Essex, 'tis true, wore a splendid ring, set with diamonds, given him by his royal mistress, whilst I—I have nothing but a simple circlet of gold, with a cipher on it and a date; but that ring has been blessed in the chapel of the Palais Royal,[1] so they will never ruin me, as they long to do, and whilst they shout, "Down with Mazarin!" I, unknown, and unperceived by them, incite them to cry out, "Long live the Duke de Beaufort" one day; another, "Long live the Prince de Condé;" and again, "Long live the parliament!"' And at this word the smile on the cardinal's lips assumed an expression of hatred, of which his mild countenance seemed incapable. 'The parliament! We shall soon see how to dispose,' he continued, 'of the parliament! Both Orléans and Montargis are ours. It will be a work of time, but those who have begun by crying out: Down with Mazarin! will finish by shouting out, Down with all the people I have mentioned, each in his turn.

Richelieu, whom they hated during his lifetime and whom they now praise after his death, was even less popular than I am. Often he was driven away, oftener still had he a dread of being sent away. The queen will never banish

[1] It is said that Mazarin, who, though a cardinal, had not taken such vows as to prevent it, was secretly married to Anne of Austria.—La Porte's Memoirs.

'As many as my lord wishes.'

'I will follow you. This way—light us downstairs, Bernouin.'

The valet held a wax-light; the cardinal took a key from his bureau and opening the door of a secret stair descended into the court of the Palais Royal.

Chapter I

The Shade of Cardinal Richelieu

In a splendid chamber of the Palais Royal, formerly styled the Palais Cardinal, a man was sitting in deep reverie, his head supported on his hands, leaning over a gilt and inlaid table which was covered with letters and papers. Behind this figure glowed a vast fireplace alive with leaping flames; great logs of oak blazed and crackled on the polished brass andirons whose flicker shone upon the superb habiliments of the lonely tenant of the room, which was illumined grandly by twin candelabra rich with wax-lights.

Any one who happened at that moment to contemplate that red simar—the gorgeous robe of office—and the rich lace, or who gazed on that pale brow, bent in anxious meditation, might, in the solitude of that apartment, combined with the silence of the ante-chambers and the measured paces of the guards upon the landing-place, have fancied that the shade of Cardinal Richelieu lingered still in his accustomed haunt.

It was, alas! the ghost of former greatness. France enfeebled, the authority of her sovereign contemned, her nobles returning to their former turbulence and insolence, her enemies within her frontiers—all proved the great Richelieu no longer in existence.

In truth, that the red simar which occupied the wonted place was his no longer, was still more strikingly obvious from the isolation which seemed, as we have observed, more appropriate to a phantom than a living creature—from the corridors deserted by courtiers, and courts crowded with guards—from that spirit of bitter ridicule, which, arising from the streets below, penetrated through the very casements of the room, which resounded with the murmurs of a whole city leagued against the minister; as well as from the distant and

Chapter II

A Nightly Patrol

In ten minutes Mazarin and his party were traversing the street 'Les Bons Enfants' behind the theatre built by Richelieu expressly for the play of 'Mirame,' and in which Mazarin, who was an amateur of music, but not of literature, had introduced into France the first opera that was ever acted in that country.

The appearance of the town denoted the greatest agitation. Numberless groups paraded the streets and, whatever D'Artagnan might think of it, it was obvious that the citizens had for the night laid aside their usual forbearance, in order to assume a warlike aspect. From time to time noises came in the direction of the public markets. The report of firearms was heard near the Rue Saint Denis and occasionally church bells began to ring indiscriminately and at the caprice of the populace. D'Artagnan, meantime, pursued his way with the indifference of a man upon whom such acts of folly made no impression. When he approached a group in the middle of the street he urged his horse upon it without a word of warning; and the members of the group, whether rebels or not, as if they knew with what sort of a man they had to deal, at once gave place to the patrol. The cardinal envied that composure, which he attributed to the habit of meeting danger; but none the less he conceived for the officer under whose orders he had for the moment placed himself, that consideration which even prudence pays to careless courage. On approaching an outpost near the Barrière des Sergens, the sentinel cried out, 'Who's there?' and D'Artagnan answered—having first asked the word of the cardinal—'Louis and Rocroy.' After which he inquired if Lieutenant Comminges were not the commanding officer at the outpost. The soldier replied by pointing out to him an officer who was conversing, on foot, his hand upon the neck of a horse on which the

individual to whom he was talking sat. Here was the officer D'Artagnan was seeking.

'Here is Monsieur Comminges,' said D'Artagnan, returning to the cardinal. He instantly retired, from a feeling of respectful delicacy; it was, however, evident that the cardinal was recognised by both Comminges and the other officers on horseback.

'Well done, Guitant,' cried the cardinal to the equestrian; 'I see plainly that, notwithstanding the sixty-four years that have passed over your head, you are still the same man, active and zealous. What were you saying to this youngster?'

'My lord,' replied Guitant, 'I was observing that we live in troublous times and that to-day's events are very like those in the days of the Ligue, of which I heard so much in my youth. Are you aware that the mob have even suggested throwing up barricades in the Rue Saint Denis and the Rue Saint Antoine?'

'And what was Comminges saying to you in reply, my good Guitant?'

'My lord,' said Comminges, 'I answered that to compose a Ligue only one ingredient was wanting—in my opinion an essential one—a Duc de Guise; moreover, no generation ever does the same thing twice.'

'No, but they mean to make a Fronde, as they call it,' said Guitant.

'And what is a Fronde?' inquired Mazarin.

'My lord, Fronde is the name the discontented give to their party.'

'And what is the origin of this name?'

'It seems that some days since Councillor Bachaumont remarked at the palace that rebels and agitators reminded him of schoolboys slinging—*qui frondent*—stones from the moats round Paris, young urchins who run off the moment the constable appears, only to return to their diversion the instant his back is turned. So they have picked up the word and the insurrectionists are called "Frondeurs," and yesterday every article sold was "à la Fronde;" bread "à la Fronde," hats "à la Fronde," to say nothing of gloves, pocket-handkerchiefs, and fans; but listen— '

At that moment a window opened and a man began to sing:

> A tempest from the Fronde
> Did blow to-day:
> I think 'twill blow
> Sieur Mazarin away.

XXV	An Adventure on the High Road	247
XXVI	The Rencontre	255
XXVII	The Four Old Friends Prepare to Meet Again	263
XXVIII	The Place Royale	273
XXIX	The Ferry Across the Oise	279
XXX	Skirmishing	289
XXXI	The Monk	295
XXXII	The Absolution	305
XXXIII	Grimaud Speaks	313
XXXIV	On the Eve of Battle	319
XXXV	A Dinner in the Old Style	331
XXXVI	A Letter from Charles the First	339
XXXVII	Cromwell's Letter	345
XXXVIII	Henrietta Maria and Mazarin	353
XXXIX	How the Unhappy Mistake Chance for Providence	359
XL	Uncle and Nephew	367
XLI	Paternal Affection	373
XLII	Another Queen in Want of Help	381
XLIII	First Impulses are Oftentimes the Best	393
XLIV	Te Deum for the Victory of Lens	401

Contents

I	The Shade of Cardinal Richelieu	1
II	A Nightly Patrol	13
III	Dead Animosities	23
IV	Anne of Austria at the Age of Forty-Six	37
V	The Gascon and the Italian	49
VI	D'Artagnan in his Fortieth Year	55
VII	The Strange Effects a Half-Pistole May Have	71
VIII	D'Artagnan, Going to a Distance to Discover Aramis	79
IX	The Abbé D'Herblay	89
X	Monsieur Porthos du Vallon de Bracieux de Pierrefonds	107
XI	Wealth Does Not Necessarily Produce Happiness	113
XII	Porthos was Discontented with his Condition	123
XIII	Two Angelic Faces	129
XIV	The Castle of Bragelonne	137
XV	Athos as a Diplomatist	145
XVI	The Duc de Beaufort	155
XVII	The Duc de Beaufort in the Donjon of Vincennes	161
XVIII	Grimaud Begins His Functions	171
XIX	Pâtés Made by the Successor of Father Marteau Are Described	183
XX	One of Marie Michon's Adventures	193
XXI	The Abbé Scarron	205
XXII	Saint Denis	217
XXIII	The Escape of the Duc de Beaufort	225
XXIV	The Timely Arrival of D'Artagnan in Paris	237

'Insolent wretch!' cried Guitant.

'My lord,' said Comminges, who, irritated by his wounds, wished for revenge and longed to give back blow for blow, 'shall I fire off a ball to punish that jester, and to warn him not to sing so much out of tune in the future?'

And as he spoke he put his hand on the holster of his uncle's saddle-bow.

'Certainly not! certainly not,' exclaimed Mazarin. '*Diavolo!* my dear friend, you are going to spoil everything—everything is going on famously. I know the French as well as if I had made them myself. They sing—let them pay the piper. During the Ligue, about which Guitant was speaking just now, the people chanted nothing except the mass, so everything went to destruction. Come, Guitant, come along, and let's see if they keep watch at the Quinze-Vingts as at the Barrière des Sergens.'

And waving his hand to Comminges he rejoined D'Artagnan, who instantly put himself at the head of his troop, followed by the cardinal, Guitant and the rest of the escort.

'Just so,' muttered Comminges, looking after Mazarin. 'True, I forgot; provided he can get money out of the people, that is all he wants.'

The street of Saint Honoré, when the cardinal and his party passed through it, was crowded by an assemblage who, standing in groups, discussed the edicts of that memorable day. They pitied the young king, who was unconsciously ruining his country, and threw all the odium of his proceedings on Mazarin. Addresses to the Duke of Orléans and to Condé were suggested. Blancmesnil and Broussel seemed in the highest favor.

D'Artagnan passed through the very midst of this discontented mob just as if his horse and he had been made of iron. Mazarin and Guitant conversed together in whispers. The musketeers, who had already discovered who Mazarin was, followed in profound silence. In the street of Saint Thomas-du-Louvre they stopped at the barrier distinguished by the name of Quinze-Vingts. Here Guitant spoke to one of the subalterns, asking how matters were progressing.

'Ah, captain!' said the officer, 'everything is quiet hereabout—if I did not know that something is going on in yonder house!'

And he pointed to a magnificent hotel situated on the very spot whereon the Vaudeville now stands.

'In that hotel? it is the Hotel Rambouillet,' cried Guitant.

'I really don't know what hotel it is; all I do know is that I observed some suspicious looking people go in there— '

'Nonsense!' exclaimed Guitant, with a burst of laughter; 'those men must be poets.'

'Come, Guitant, speak, if you please, respectfully of these gentlemen,' said Mazarin; 'don't you know that I was in my youth a poet? I wrote verses in the style of Benserade— '

'*You*, my lord?'

'Yes, I; shall I repeat to you some of my verses?'

'Just as you please, my lord. I do not understand Italian.'

'Yes, but you understand French,' and Mazarin laid his hand upon Guitant's shoulder. 'My good, my brave Guitant, whatsoever command I may give you in that language—in French—whatever I may order you to do, will you not perform it?'

'Certainly. I have already answered that question in the affirmative; but that command must come from the queen herself.'

'Yes! ah yes!' Mazarin bit his lips as he spoke; 'I know your devotion to her majesty.'

'I have been a captain in the queen's guards for twenty years,' was the reply.

'*En route*, Monsieur d'Artagnan,' said the cardinal; 'all goes well in this direction.'

D'Artagnan, in the meantime, had taken the head of his detachment without a word and with that ready and profound obedience which marks the character of an old soldier.

He led the way toward the hill of Saint Roche. The Rue Richelieu and the Rue Villedot were then, owing to their vicinity to the ramparts, less frequented than any others in that direction, for the town was thinly inhabited thereabout.

'Who is in command here?' asked the cardinal.

'Villequier,' said Guitant.

'*Diavolo!* Speak to him yourself, for ever since you were deputed by me to arrest the Duc de Beaufort, this officer and I have been on bad terms. He laid claim to that honour as captain of the royal guards.'

'I am aware of that, and I have told him a hundred times that he was wrong. The king could not give that order, since at that time he was hardly four years old.'

Twenty Years Later

vol. 1

Alexandre Dumas

illus. David Ljungdahl